

COVER STORY: PAKISTAN

THE CHALLENGERS

44

Former prime minister Nawaz Sharif returns from exile with Benazir Bhutto while General Musharraf quits as army chief. But will they be able to thwart his plans?

PLUS: EXCLUSIVE INTERVIEW WITH NAWAZ SHARIF



STATES: GUJARAT



Taking on Goliath 30

Dinsha Patel's impeccable image and unimpeachable integrity ensures that he is Congress's best bet to take on Chief Minister Narendra Modi.

BUSINESS&ECONOMY: SENSEX

Is the Party Over? 38

With foreign money and sentiment driving the Indian markets, the Sensex is only a short distance away from the bubble zone. And as China and the US slow down, India is bound to be affected.



NATION: TASLIMA NASREEN

Writer Blocked 18



Taslma Nasreen is a writer on the run around whom minority politics is being played out with brazen competitiveness.

ENVIRONMENT: RAT ATTACK

Flower of famine 62

Bamboo plants flower again in Mizoram after 48 years but they bring killer rats that are devastating crops leading to a deadly famine.

SOCIETY&THE ARTS: FERTILITY

Late Bloomers 76



Baby hunger is no longer a permanent affliction as urban Indian women turn to fertility treatments.

OFFTRACK.....	10
INDIASCOPE.....	12
STATES.....	30
SOCIETY AND THE ARTS.....	72
YOUR WEEK.....	89
EYECATCHERS.....	96

Jobs Today Turn to pg 94

Take a look at the latest job offers in the Market.

COVER BY
SAURABH SINGH

Best Buy
Compact
Sport-utility
Vehicle
2008

by US Consumer
Guide (Automotive)

GRAND
VITARA
Play it your way